

Project Status Report: Interior Design Marketplace

1. How the Platform Works (User Flow)

- **Landing Page & Role Selection:** When users visit the website, they can join as a 'Customer' (to find a designer) or a 'Vendor' (to provide interior design services).
- **The Customer Journey:**
 - A customer searches for vendors based on their city and required category (like Home Decor, Full Renovation, or Furniture).
 - They view the vendor's profile, including their past projects and shop details.
 - They send a direct "Quote Request" explaining what they need.
 - Customers have a personal dashboard to track the status of their quotes (Pending, Accepted, or Declined).
- **The Vendor Journey:**
 - A vendor creates an account and sets up their online shop by uploading their shop logo, banner, and interior design photos.
 - Vendors get all quote requests directly on their dashboard.
 - They can read the customer's requirements and choose to Accept or Decline the project lead.
- **The Admin Journey:** The platform admin uses the master panel to verify and approve new vendors and manage the categories on the website.

2. Technology Stack Used

- **Frontend:** Next.js and React.js
- **Backend:** Java Spring Boot
- **Database:** MongoDB
- **Security:** JWT (JSON Web Tokens)

3. Features Developed So Far

- **Dual-Role System:** Built a secure login and signup system for both Customers and Vendors.
- **Search & Explore:** Customers can browse through the list of vendors without creating an account.
- **Vendor Profiles:** Built dynamic profile pages for vendors where they can show their shop details and work gallery.
- **Quote Request System:** Created the complete flow for customers to send specific design requirements to vendors.
- **Vendor Dashboard:** Built a dedicated dashboard for interior designers to update their shop details and manage incoming leads.
- **Master Admin Console:** Created a centralized admin panel to approve or block users and monitor the platform.

4. Ideas for Future Additions

To make this platform perfect for interior design, here are some features we can add next:

- **Shareable Profile Links:** Giving every vendor a custom URL (like `website.com/vendor-name`) so they can share it on WhatsApp or Instagram to get clients.
- **"Before & After" Portfolios:** Allowing vendors to upload Before and After photos of their interior projects to build trust with customers.
- **Customer 'Idea Boards':** A feature where customers can save design photos they like and share this board with their vendor to explain their vision.
- **Tiered Service Catalogs:** Allowing vendors to list both small services (like "Decor Consultation") and big projects (like "Full Room Design") with basic pricing.
- **In-App Direct Chat:** A simple chat system for customers and vendors to share reference photos and messages without sharing personal phone numbers.
- **Verified Badges:** Adding trust badges (like "Verified Pro") to vendor profiles to help customers choose reliable designers.